

Ilya Fedorov - Head of Engineering

CONTACT

Ilya Fedorov

- +64 21 071 0620
- ilya.fedorov@gmail.com
- [linkedin.com/in/ilyafedorov](https://www.linkedin.com/in/ilyafedorov)
- Auckland, New Zealand
- New Zealand citizen

SUMMARY

- Head of Engineering with 20+ years across software development, system design, and organisational leadership - currently leading adoption of agentic coding tooling and AI-powered engineering workflows at an AI/ML company, with a focus on automating toil and measurably increasing delivery velocity.
- Proven scale-up leader from a customer-facing online product background, with a track record of building high-performing engineering teams and improving delivery predictability across high-growth SaaS environments.
- Pragmatic and technically grounded: navigates trade-offs between technical debt and delivery velocity, balances rapid shipping with platform stability, and knows when an MVP scope is the smarter call.
- Experienced operating at board and senior executive level - articulates Engineering Health in business terms, influences stakeholders to invest in the right areas, and ensures engineering priorities sit alongside product features in leadership conversations.
- Builds high-velocity engineering cultures grounded in ownership and psychological safety: coaches talent, raises engineering maturity, and creates the conditions for a predictable, world-class team.
- Translates business vision into technology strategy and leads end-to-end execution - from architectural stewardship and operating model design to team capability development.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Mindhive - Head of Engineering

Feb 2025 - Present · Full-time · AI/ML, industrial computer vision

AI/ML company delivering industrial computer vision solutions for automated grading, defect detection, and operational workflows.

Highlights

- Led adoption of AI-assisted engineering practices and agentic coding tooling across a globally distributed team, measurably increasing delivery velocity and automating engineering toil.
- Designed and implemented a delivery cadence to reduce disruption from reactive demand and improve predictability across Engineering, Product, and Customer Success.

- Introduced structured intake, triage, and prioritisation - creating Engineering Health visibility for leadership and reducing unplanned work.
- Implemented engineering flow metrics to surface demand patterns, delivery performance, and systemic constraints.
- Strengthened platform operations and follow-the-sun support capability, improving resilience for a 24/7 production environment.
- Led engineering across software, platform, and ML delivery in a globally distributed startup (NZ, Brazil, Europe).
- Contributed to SLT and board discussions on capacity, prioritisation, security posture, and organisational design.

Tech: React.js, Angular.js, Python, AWS, DataDog, JIRA, Confluence

Tradify - Senior Software Engineering Manager

Dec 2023 - Feb 2025 · Full-time · SaaS, field service management

High-growth SaaS platform for trades businesses, scaling rapidly across international markets.

Highlights

- Initiated frontend modernisation from AngularJS to React, designed the zero-downtime migration approach, and established the architectural foundation for a scalable platform.
- Introduced flow metrics across engineering and product, enabling data-driven delivery decisions and improving delivery predictability.
- Established structured initiatives to address technical debt and improve Engineering Health, balancing platform stability with shipping velocity.
- Identified and resolved systemic platform misuse, reducing spamming incidents by ~75%.
- Transitioned performance management to a continuous feedback model, improving engagement and professional growth across teams.
- Strengthened engineering culture, increasing psychological safety and team effectiveness.
- Led multiple engineering teams, aligning delivery with product strategy and scaling objectives.
- Acted as the primary interface between engineering and senior leadership on delivery, health, and platform risk.

Tech: AngularJS, React

Te Kete Hono - Head of Technology

May 2020 - Oct 2024 · Contract · EdTech, SaaS

Social impact enterprise backed by Hugh Green Foundation, delivering 3 SaaS products to 20,000+ users across the education sector.

Highlights

- Transitioned architecture to microservices, improving average response times by 30% and by 75% during peak hours.
- Planned and executed infrastructure modernisation and cloud provider migration, reducing operational costs by 50%.
- Implemented Secure Development Lifecycle practices; passed an external security audit with zero risks reported and 100% compliance.

- Delivered an ed-tech product on-time and under budget, reducing time-to-market by 25% through agile methodologies.
- Developed a 3-year technology roadmap aligned with business objectives, covering product and infrastructure evolution.
- Established a technology governance framework driving development excellence across 3 SaaS products.
- Built and led a high-performing, self-organising team of 6 technology professionals.
- Managed board and stakeholder relationships, communicating engineering priorities, capacity, and strategic direction at executive level.
- Drove company-wide culture change toward a high-trust, high-ownership engineering environment.
- Supported the board through a business sale, articulating product value, architecture, and technical foundations to due diligence participants.

Tech: JavaScript ES6, React, C# .NET, Azure Functions, Entity Framework, SQL Server, Cosmos DB, Azure DevOps, CI/CD pipelines, SonarCloud

Serko - Software Engineering Manager

Aug 2019 - Apr 2020 · Contract · Corporate travel and expense management, SaaS

Technology company offering intelligent corporate travel and expense solutions, controlling more than 70% of the corporate travel market in New Zealand and Australia.

Highlights

- Championed a "build it and own it" ownership culture - developers took end-to-end accountability for the software they built.
- Built a tightly knit team of 6 developers and fostered a safe, open culture across 5 teams.
- Coached developers through pair and mob programming, improving team performance by 50%.
- Reduced error rates on critical pathways by 90%.
- Guided teams to stabilise the product: improved production visibility, removed the fear of deployment, and raised engineering maturity.
- Facilitated a company-wide shift from startup to scale-up mentality, realigning team structure to product and business objectives.

Tech: React, Redux, TypeScript, Node.js, C# .NET, Azure Cloud, Azure DevOps, SQL Server

Propellerhead - Product Owner / Development Manager

Oct 2017 - Nov 2019 · Contract · Digital consultancy

Digital consultancy helping businesses make pragmatic and cost-efficient technology decisions across government, commercial, and startup sectors.

Highlights

- Led 3 distributed teams across multiple concurrent client engagements.
- Managed deliverables across 10 vendors; aligned client expectations with product roadmaps and delivery capacity.
- Defined product vision, architecture, and technical strategy - communicated to clients and internal stakeholders.

- Delivered an MVP for an NZ-based AML startup on time and within budget.
- Established technical practices to improve delivery team quality and address technical debt.

Tech: Azure, AWS, React, Redux, TypeScript, Node.js, C# .NET, MySQL, MongoDB, Cosmos DB

Schooltalk - Co-founder / Software Engineering Manager

Jan 2015 - Sep 2017 · Co-founder · EdTech, SaaS

Social impact startup building a platform for teachers to track student progress, monitor engagement, and assess achievement.

Highlights

- Co-founded and built a SaaS platform from concept to production.
- Secured funding through grants and stakeholder engagement.
- Built and led engineering capability from the ground up, introducing agile delivery practices.

Tech: JavaScript, React.js, C#, ASP.Net MVC, Azure App Services, AWS Lambda, SQL Server

Fraedom - Senior Full-Stack Software Developer

Apr 2013 - Jan 2015 · Full-time · FinTech, expense management

Technology partner of VISA providing Total Transaction Management solutions.

Freightways - Senior Analyst-Programmer

Nov 2007 - Mar 2013 · Full-time · Logistics and courier services

New Zealand courier and logistics company operating NZ Couriers, DX Mail, Post Haste, and Castle Parcels.

Thor United - Senior Analyst-Programmer

Feb 2006 - Nov 2007 · Full-time · Investment and financial services

Investment company based in Russia/USA.

Nicotech International - Analyst-Programmer

Apr 2005 - Oct 2005 · Full-time · Software development

Software house.

Sportmaster - Analyst-Programmer

Sep 2001 - Apr 2005 · Full-time · Retail, sportswear

Leading sportswear retailer in Russia.

EDUCATION

- Postgraduate Diploma in Information Technology and Computer Science - Auckland University of Technology
- Postgraduate Diploma in Business Analysis - Russian Academy of National Economy
- Master of Applied Physics and Mathematics - Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & COMMUNITY

- Executive coaching with Noah Cantor (2024-present)
- Executive coaching with Paul Birch (2025-present)
- Founded and facilitate a peer forum of engineering leaders (Canva, Gentrack, Fintfox) focused on scaling teams, delivery systems, and leadership effectiveness
- Mentor at University of Auckland Chiasma programme